

**Honors Journalism & Video Production**  
**Brecksville-Broadview Heights High School**  
**2025-2026**

**MODEL CURRICULUM: LEARNING PROGRESSIONS**

**QUARTER 1 -- UNIT 1**

| Topic/<br>Focus      | General<br>Pacing<br>(days -<br>weeks) | State Learning Standards (highlight power<br>standards)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Key Vocabulary                                                                                                                                                                                          | Learning Targets (student<br>friendly)<br>I am learning:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Link to Assessments & Resources            |
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| Unit 1: Media<br>Law | 1-2<br>weeks                           | <b>First Quarter</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>W.11-12.8 - Gather relevant information from multiple authoritative print and digital sources, using advanced searches effectively; assess the strengths and limitations of each source in terms of the task, purpose, and audience; integrate information into the text selectively to maintain the flow of ideas, avoiding plagiarism and overreliance on any one source and following a standard format for citation.</li> <li>W.11-12.9 - Draw evidence from literary or informational texts to support analysis, reflection, and research. <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>a. Apply grades 11–12 Reading standards to literature (e.g., “Demonstrate</li> </ul> </li> </ul> | Functions of Journalism<br>Unprotected Speech<br>Libel/Slander<br>Intrusion<br>False Light<br>Appropriation<br>Tinker v. Des Moines<br>Peter Zenger Trial<br>Fraser v. Bethel<br>Hazelwood v. Kuhlmeier | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>I can gather information from various sources regarding media law cases and their practical applications for publications and classroom use.</li> <li>I can research court cases and other relevant casework from the Supreme Court and other seminal works and demonstrate knowledge on how they will work in the classroom and real world settings.</li> </ul> | <a href="#">Media Law/Ethics Materials</a> |

knowledge of eighteenth-, nineteenth- and early twentieth-century foundational works of American literature, including how two or more diverse texts from the same period treat similar themes and/or topics”).

- b. Apply grades 11–12 Reading standards to literary nonfiction (e.g., “Delineate and evaluate the reasoning in seminal U.S. texts, including the application of constitutional principles and use of legal reasoning [e.g., in U.S. Supreme Court Case majority opinions and dissents] and the premises, purposes, and arguments in works of public advocacy [e.g., The Federalist, presidential addresses]”).

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| Unit 2:<br>Commercials |  | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>W.11-12.4 - Produce clear and coherent writing in which the development, organization, and style are appropriate to task, purpose, and audience. (Grade-specific expectations for writing types are defined in standards 1–3 above.)</li> <li>W.11-12.5 - Develop and strengthen writing as needed by planning, revising, editing, rewriting, or trying a new approach, focusing on addressing what is most significant for a specific purpose and audience. (Editing for conventions should demonstrate command of Language standards 1–3 up to and including grades 11–12.)</li> <li>W.11-12.6 - Use technology, including the Internet, to produce, publish, and update individual or shared writing products in response to ongoing feedback, including new arguments or information.</li> <li>SL.11-12.6 - Adapt speech to a variety of contexts and tasks, demonstrating a command of formal English when indicated or appropriate. (See grades</li> </ul> | <b>Ethos</b><br><b>Pathos</b><br><b>Logos</b><br><b>Appeals</b><br><b>Audience</b><br><b>Problem/Solution</b><br><b>and structures</b><br><b>Pitch</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>I can produce a clear and coherent script appropriate to the task of my commercial.</li> <li>I can develop and strengthen my writing as needed by planning, revising, editing, rewriting, or trying a new approach, focusing on what is most significant for my audience.</li> <li>I can use technology to produce, publish, and update my work.</li> <li>I can adapt the work to a variety of contexts and audiences.</li> </ul> |  |

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|                    |                                                     | 11–12 Language standards 1 and 3 for specific expectations.)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                 |
| Unit 3: News Media | 1 week initial instruction, continuing through year | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>W.11-12.6 - Use technology, including the Internet, to produce, publish, and update individual or shared writing products in response to ongoing feedback, including new arguments or information.</li> <li>SL.11-12.6 - Adapt speech to a variety of contexts and tasks, demonstrating a command of formal English when indicated or appropriate. (See grades 11–12 Language standards 1 and 3 for specific expectations.)</li> </ul> | <b>Newsworthiness</b><br><b>Pronunciation</b><br><b>Elocution</b><br><b>Articulation</b><br><b>Standups</b><br><b>Man on the Street</b><br><b>Interviewing</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>I can use technology to produce, publish, and update news stories and update as needed for credibility.</li> <li>I can adapt speech to the context of news broadcasts and demonstrate command of formal English while reporting.</li> </ul> | <a href="#">Broadcast Units</a> |

## QUARTER 2 -

| Topic/<br>Focus       | Pacing                    | State Learning Standards (highlight power standards)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Key Vocabulary                                                                                                                     | Learning Targets (student friendly)<br>I am learning:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Link to Assessments & Resources       |
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| Unit 1: Documentaries | 9 weeks - ongoing project | <b>Second Quarter</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>W.11-12.2 Write informative/explanatory texts to examine and convey complex ideas, concepts, and information clearly and accurately through the effective selection, organization, and analysis of content. <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>a. Establish a clear and thorough thesis to</li> </ul> </li> </ul> | Purpose<br>Audience<br>Observational<br>Lifestyle/Subculture<br>Cultural/Anthropological<br>B-Roll<br>Interviewing<br>Lower Thirds | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>I can create informative works examining and conveying complex ideas and information clearly and accurately.</li> <li>I can establish a clear thesis/topic to present and explain information</li> <li>-I can introduce and organize complex ideas so that they build to create a unified whole.</li> <li>I can develop the topic by selecting the most significant and relevant</li> </ul> | <a href="#">Documentary Resources</a> |

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|  |  | <p>present and explain information.</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>○ b. Introduce a topic; organize complex ideas, concepts, and information so that each new element builds on that which precedes it to create a unified whole; include formatting (e.g., headings), graphics (e.g., figures, tables), and multimedia to aid comprehension, if needed.</li> <li>○ c. Develop the topic thoroughly by selecting the most significant and relevant facts, extended definitions, concrete details, quotations, or other information and examples appropriate to the audience's knowledge of the topic.</li> <li>○ d. Use appropriate and varied transitions and syntax to link the major sections of the text, create cohesion, and clarify the relationships among complex ideas and concepts.</li> <li>○ g. Provide a concluding</li> </ul> |  | <p>facts, details and quotations to allow the audience to understand the topic.</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- I can use appropriate transitions to link major sections and topics to create clarity and cohesion for the viewer.</li> <li>- I can provide a conclusion that supports the preceding information.</li> </ul> |  |
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|                                        |                                   | statement or section that follows from and supports the information or explanation presented (e.g., articulating implications or the significance of the topic).                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                        |
| <b>Unit 2 - Social Media Marketing</b> | <b>Intro 1 week, ongoing unit</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>● W.11-12.2 Write informative/explanatory texts to examine and convey complex ideas, concepts, and information clearly and accurately through the effective selection, organization, and analysis of content. <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>○ e. Use precise language, domain-specific vocabulary, and techniques such as metaphor, simile, and analogy to manage the complexity of the topic.</li> <li>○ f. Establish and maintain a formal style and objective tone while attending to the norms and conventions of the discipline in which they are writing.</li> </ul> </li> </ul> | <b>Demographics</b><br><b>Geographics</b><br><b>Psychographics</b><br><b>Behaviorgraphics</b><br><b>Persona</b><br><b>Marketing strategy</b><br><b>Graphic Design</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- I can create informative texts explaining and conveying complex ideas to market a product.</li> <li>- I can use precise, specific language and use techniques like metaphor, simile, and analogies to manage complexity of marketing topics.</li> <li>- I can establish and maintain a formal style appropriate to the conventions in which I am writing.</li> </ul> | <a href="#">Social Media Materials</a> |
| <b>QUARTER 3</b>                       |                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                        |

| Unit 1 - Podcasting |  | <b>Third Quarter</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>RI.11-12.1 Cite strong and thorough textual evidence to support analysis of what the text says explicitly as well as inferences drawn from the text, including determining where the text leaves matters uncertain.</li> <li>RI.11-12.2 Analyze informational text development. <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>a. Determine two or more central ideas of a text and analyze their development over the course of the text, including how they interact and build on one another.</li> <li>b. Craft an informative abstract that delineates how the central ideas of a text interact and build on one another.</li> </ul> </li> <li>RI.11-12.3 Analyze a complex set of ideas or sequence of events and explain how specific individuals, ideas, or events interact and develop over the course of the text.</li> <li>RI.11-12.4 Determine the meaning of words and phrases as they are used in a text, including figurative, connotative, and technical meanings; analyze how an author uses and refines the meaning of a key term or terms</li> </ul> | <b>Storytelling</b><br><b>Teaching</b><br><b>Informational</b><br><b>Speaking Style</b><br><b>Story Structure</b><br><b>Style</b><br><b>Substance</b><br><b>Trailers</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>I can cite strong evidence to support my topics and presentation.</li> <li>I can analyze a central idea and how it's developed in my podcast and in texts I am analyzing/discussing within it.</li> <li>I can craft an informative abstract showing how central ideas interact with one another.</li> <li>I can analyze a complex set of ideas and events and explain how they develop and interact using my podcast.</li> <li>I can discuss the meaning of words and phrases and their greater meanings in the development of my own product.</li> </ul> | <a href="#">Podcasting Materials</a> |
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|                                                                    |                | over the course of a text (e.g., how Madison defines faction in Federalist No. 10).                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                             |
| <b>Unit 2:<br/>Documentary/<br/>News/Podcast<br/>Analysis Unit</b> | <b>2 weeks</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>● RI.11-12.5 Analyze and evaluate the effectiveness of the structure an author uses in his or her exposition or argument, including whether the structure makes points clear, convincing, and engaging.</li> <li>● RI.11-12.6 Determine an author's perspective or purpose in a text in which the rhetoric is particularly effective, analyzing how style and content contribute to the power, persuasiveness, or beauty of the text.</li> <li>● RI.11-12.7 Integrate and evaluate multiple sources of information presented in different media or formats (e.g., visually, quantitatively) as well as in words in order to address a question or solve a problem.</li> </ul> | <b>-Rhetoric<br/>-Structure<br/>-Evaluating</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- I can analyze and evaluate the effectiveness of the structure an author uses in their argument, including whether the structure makes points clear, convincing, and engaging.</li> <li>- I can determine an author's perspective or purpose in a text where the rhetoric is particularly effective and analyze how the content contributes to its effectiveness.</li> <li>- I can integrate and evaluate multiple sources of information to address how to increase effectiveness of my own messaging.</li> </ul> | <b>Will use materials from units as well as various documentaries, podcasts, newscasts.</b> |
| <b>Quarter 4</b>                                                   |                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                             |



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| Unit 1: PSAs | 4 weeks | <b>Fourth Quarter</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>W.11-12.7 - Conduct short as well as more sustained research projects to answer a question (including a self-generated question) or solve a problem; narrow or broaden the inquiry when appropriate; synthesize multiple sources on the subject, demonstrating understanding of the subject under investigation.</li> <li>SL.11-12.4 - Present information, findings, and supporting evidence, conveying a clear and distinct perspective, such that listeners can follow the line of reasoning, alternative or opposing perspectives are addressed, and the organization, development, substance, and style are appropriate to purpose, audience, and a range of formal and informal tasks.</li> <li>SL.11-12.5 - Make strategic use of digital media (e.g., textual, graphical, audio, visual, and interactive elements) in presentations to enhance understanding of findings, reasoning, and evidence and to add interest.</li> </ul> | <b>Persuasion</b><br><b>Mood evoking</b><br><b>Problem/Solution</b><br><b>Call to action</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>- I can conduct short and sustained research to answer a problem.</li> <li>- I can demonstrate understanding of the subject and adjust inquiries as necessary.</li> <li>- I can present information and findings to support evidence.</li> <li>- I can allow listeners to follow a clear line of reasoning and perspectives with a style appropriate to the task.</li> <li>- I can make strategic use of digital media to enhance audience understanding of findings, adding reasoning and evidence to add interest.</li> </ul> | <a href="#">PSA Materials</a> |
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| <b>Unit 2:<br/>Trailer/Portfolio Project</b> | <b>4 weeks</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>● SL.11-12.6 - Adapt speech to a variety of contexts and tasks, demonstrating a command of formal English when indicated or appropriate. (See grades 11–12 Language standards 1 and 3 for specific expectations.)</li> <li>● W.11-12.5 - Develop and strengthen writing as needed by planning, revising, editing, rewriting, or trying a new approach, focusing on addressing what is most significant for a specific purpose and audience. (Editing for conventions should demonstrate command of Language standards 1–3 up to and including grades 11–12.)</li> <li>● W.11-12.6 - Use technology, including the Internet, to produce, publish, and update individual or shared writing products in response to ongoing feedback, including new arguments or information.</li> </ul> | Genres<br>Editing<br>Portfolios<br>Mixing<br>Editing<br>Mood | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>● I can adapt works and speech to a variety of different contexts.</li> <li>● I can revise and edit a work to create a new effect or to create a preview of the overall works.</li> <li>● I can use technology to produce, publish, and update these works.</li> </ul> | <a href="#">Trailer &amp; Portfolio Materials</a> |
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